

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 10

**POST-MAURYAN ART AND
ARCHITECTURE**

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous module

5

SCULPTURES



4 Two of the famous sculptures of the Mauryan period are those of Yaksha and Yakshinis.

5 They were objects of the worship related to all the three religions - Jainism, Buddhism and Hinduism.

6 The earliest mention of Yakshini can be found in Silappatikaram, a Tamil text.

7 Similarly, all of the Jain Tirthankaras were associated with the Yakshini.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous module

5

SCULPTURES

Some of the important sculptures are described here:

DIDARGANJ YAKSHINI



1

This is a life size, free standing statue of a Yakshini discovered in **Didarganj region near Patna** and hence it got its name.

2

It is a masterpiece of sculpture , the sandstone figure shows a Yakshini holding a **Chauri (fly whisk)**.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous module

5

SCULPTURES

PARKHAM YAKSHA



1

This is another great masterpiece of this period.

2

It is a life-size statue of Yaksha made of red sand stone found near Mathura.

3

The muscular body and the folds of the garments of the lower body are striking.

4

However the statue is not as well preserved as that of the Didarganj Yakshini.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

*Seen in previous
module*

5

SCULPTURES

ROCK-CUT ELEPHANT AT DHAULI



- 1 This monumental rock-cut elephant found at **Dhauli in Odisha** is another important specimen of sculpture of this period.
- 2 Built by **Emperor Ashoka**, the elephant is placed above his rock-edict inscribed on which is **Ashoka's concern for the whole World**.
- 3 This place is believed to be sight of the **Kalinga war**.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous module

6

ROCK-CUT CAVES

- 5 The outer facade of the Barabar caves has a chaitya arch which is semi-circular.



Lomus Rishi caves in Barabar Hills

- 6 The rectangular interior hall has a circular chamber at the back.

- 7 These chambers are carved out of Granite rock and bear highly polished internal surface.

- 8 Barabar caves was a center of the followers of the Ajivika sect. Also present at the site are several rock-cut Buddhist and Hindu sculptures and inscriptions from later period.

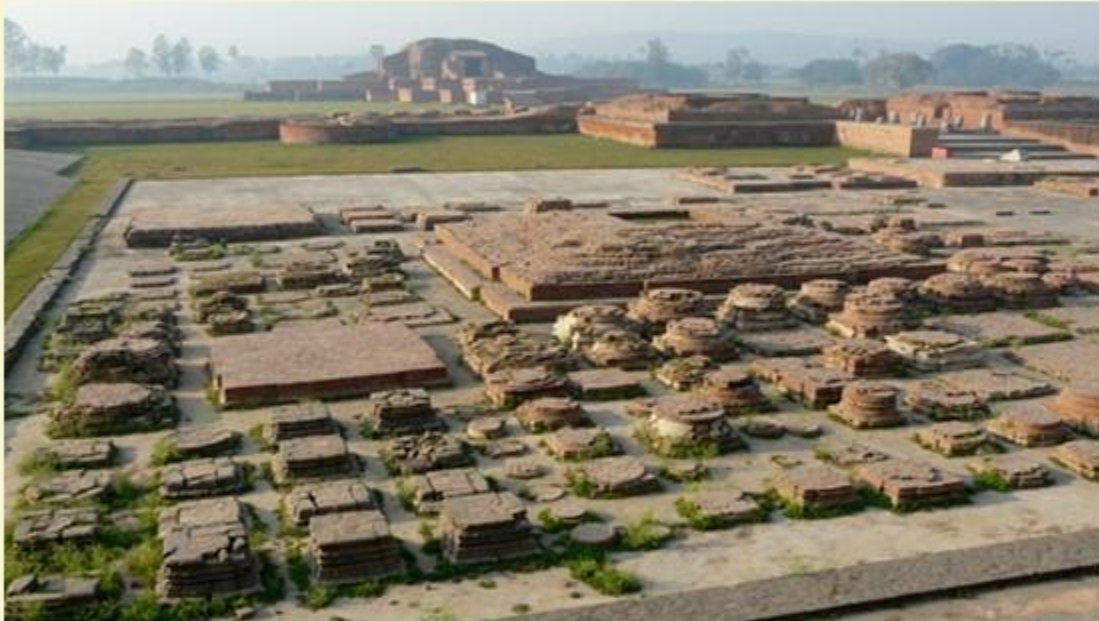
- 9 These caves got the patronage of both emperor Ashoka and Dasharath Maurya.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous
module

6

PALACES



Ruins of the 80 pillared hall in Kumrahar

5

Megasthenes, the Greek ambassador sent by Seleucus Nicator to the Court of Chandragupta Maurya, described the palace as one of the greatest creations of man kind.

6

Similarly, Ashoka's palace at Kumrahar, Patna the remains of which can still be seen had a grand 80 pillared Assembly hall.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous module

7

POTTERY



- 1 Pottery on the Mauryan period is generally referred to as **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)**.
- 2 They were characterized by black paint.
- 3 They have highly lustrous finish and were generally used as luxury items.
- 4 It was made of final Alluvial clay. It was found in abundance in the Gangetic valley and they were **often referred to as the highest level of pottery**.

ELEMENTS OF MAURYAN ARCHITECTURE

Seen in previous module

8

COINS



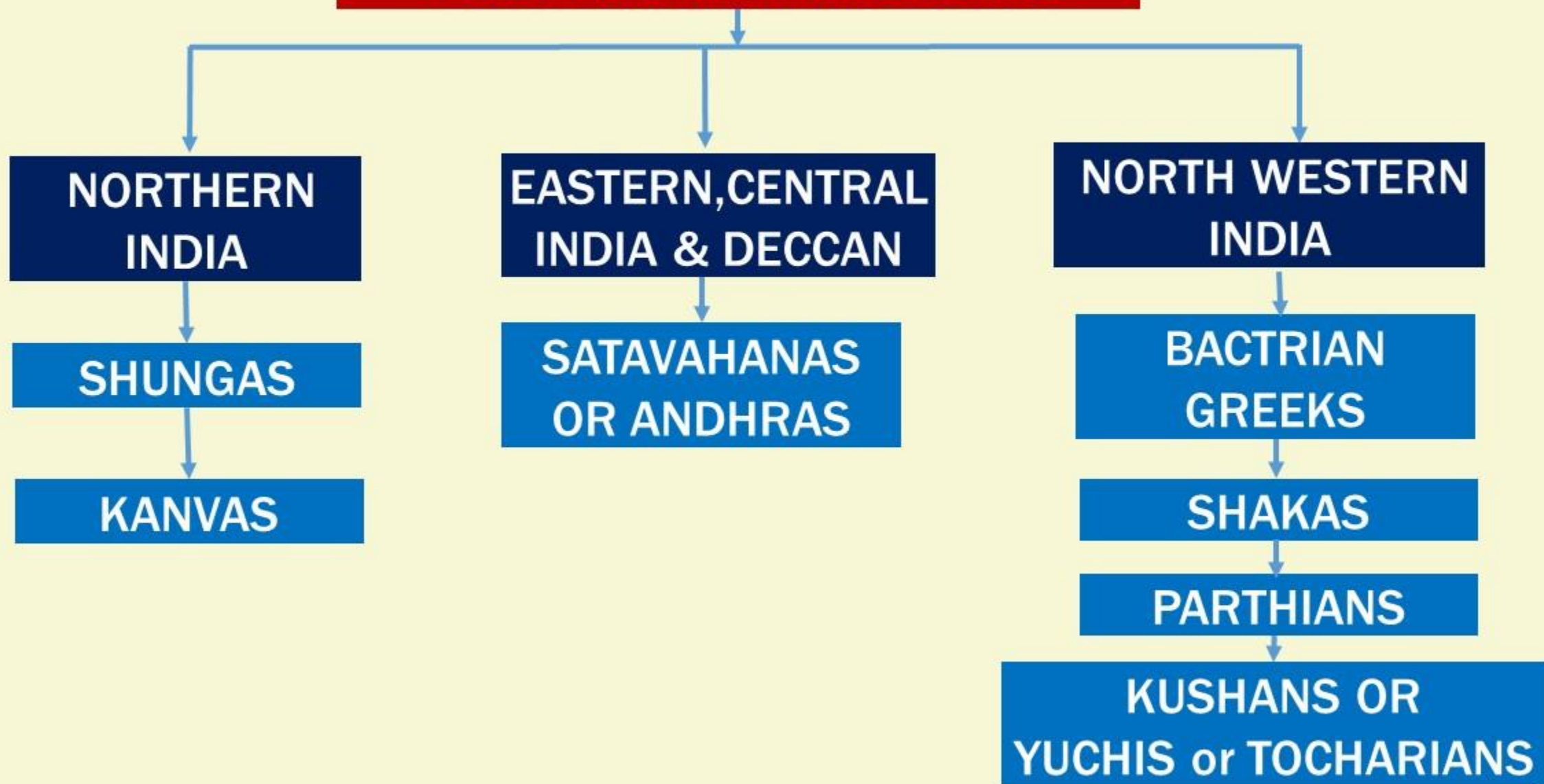
- 1 The coins in the Mauryan period were usually of silver besides a few of copper.
- 2 These were of various shapes and sizes and carry different figures as that of animals, trees etc.
- 3 The metal was first cut and then the figures were punched.
- 4 These punch marked coins represented either royal symbols or the symbols of the local guilds (traders guild who are issuing it).

POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE



- 1 Art and Culture in Ancient India has been deeply influenced by the political regime and its patronization of the religious thought.
- 2 While in Mauryan period, Buddhist thought and culture was predominant, in the post Mauryan period, the Gupta period and post Gupta period, different social religious influences dominated Art and Culture.

POST-MAURYAN KINGDOMS



POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

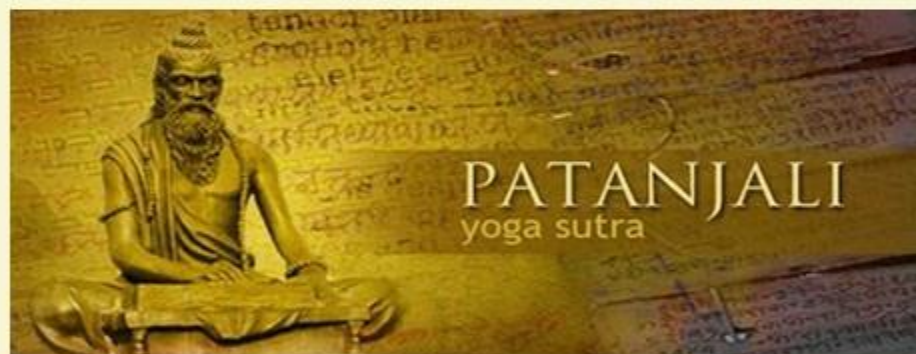
SUNGA DYNASTY



- 1 The Sunga Dynasty (187 BCE to 75 BCE) founded by **Pushyamitra Sunga**, succeeded the Mauryan Dynasty.
- 2 The Sungas were Brahmanical Dynasty and this is the period that also **saw rise in Vaishnavism and Shaivism**, which reached its peak during the Gupta period
- 3 During the rule of Pushyamitra Sunga (and his successors Agnimitra, Vasumitra and Devbhuti), **the royal patronage shifted from Buddhism to Brahmanism**.

POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

SUNGA DYNASTY



4

The salient contribution/developments in the field of Art and Culture in this period are as follows:

- **Mathura School of Art**, (a counterpart of Gandhara School of Art) flourished in this period.
- Hindu Philosophy flourished. Important works such as **Patanjali's yoga sutras** and **Mahabhashya** (a treatise of Sanskrit grammar) is said to be composed during this period.
- Buddhist shrines such as stupas at Sanchi and Bharhut started during the Mauryan period **underwent architectural expansions**.

POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

KANVA DYNASTY

Rulers of Kanva dynasty

Vasudeva (c. 75 – c. 66 BCE)

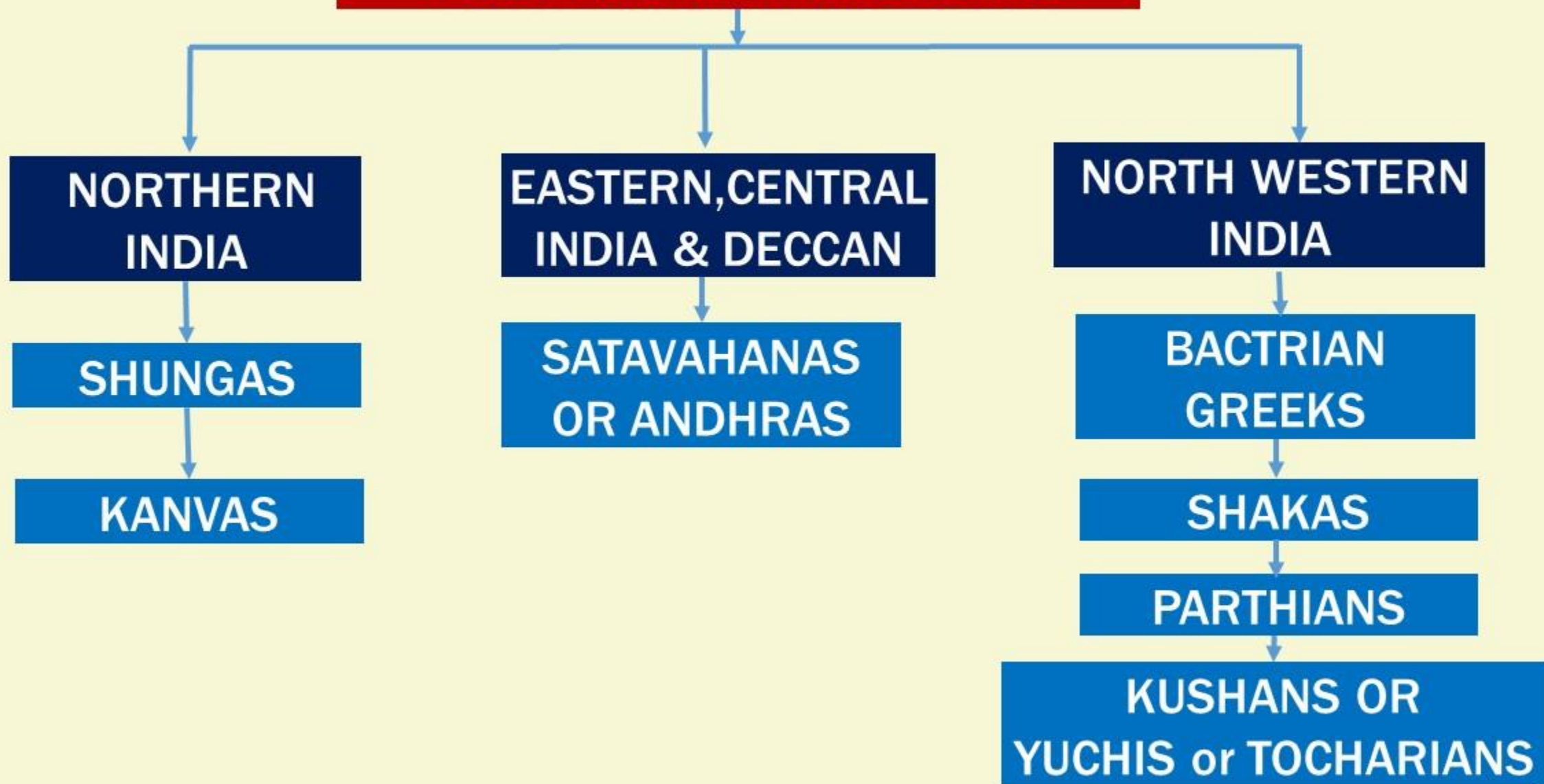
Bhumimitra (c. 66 – c. 52 BCE)

Narayana (c. 52 – c. 40 BCE)

Susharman (c. 40 – c. 30 BCE)

- 1 The Kanva Dynasty (75 BCE to 30 BCE) which overthrew the Sungas was short-lived.
- 2 Founded by **Vasudeva Kanva**, it was Brahmanical dynasty and **continued the support of Shaivism and Vaishnavism**.
- 3 This further **pushed the Buddhist influence to Central India** (from Magada region and Northern India).
- 4 This dynasty was brought to an end by the Satavahanas.

POST-MAURYAN KINGDOMS



POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

SATAVAHANA DYNASTY



- 1 This dynasty came to power in southern part of the India (Deccan Region) and reached its zenith under the reign Gautamiputra Satkarni.
- 2 Although they were Hindu Kings (descendants of the solar dynasty—Suryavanshi) they were supporters of Buddhism as well as Brahmanism.

POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

SATAVAHANA DYNASTY



3

Their salient contribution to the cultural landscape is as follows:

- The **Grand Stupa of Amravati** (Andhra Pradesh) and the other stupas in the Krishna River valley were built during this period.
- The gateways at Sanchi Stupa is believed to have been started/built by them.
- This regime helped in the spread of Hindu culture to Southeast Asia.
- It issued its own coins with portrait of rulers.
- **Prakrit** was used in official communications, coins etc and as a language of administration.

POST-MAURYAN KINGDOMS

EASTERN, CENTRAL
INDIA & DECCAN

SATAVAHANAS
OR ANDHRAS

POINTS FOR EXAMINATION

1. *Matrilineal structure*
2. *Land grants*
3. *Rock-cut architecture in K-G region*
4. *Prakrit as language-
Gathasaptasati of Hala*

POST-MAURYAN KINGDOMS



POINTS FOR EXAMINATION

1. Shih Huang Ti
2. Milinda / Menander
3. Greeks- first to issue gold coins
4. Shakas- Rudradaman I
5. Parthians- Gondophernes
6. Kushans- large number of gold coins with higher degree of purity
7. Kanishka- saka era; 4th Buddhist council.
8. Kushans- better cavalry; use of reins and saddles; introduced turbans, tunics, trousers and heavy long coat.

POST-MAURYAN KINGDOMS



POINTS FOR EXAMINATION

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POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

KUSHANA DYNASTY

- 1 The Kushana Dynasty came into prominence in the northern and northwestern part of the country in the first century CE.
- 2 It also covered the present day Pakistan and large parts of Afghanistan.
- 3 It was established by King Kujula Kadphises (in 78 CE).
- 4 Emperor Kanishka was the most prominent ruler of this dynasty.
- 5 The early Kushana rulers are believed to have been influenced by Hinduism and called themselves Devaputra (Son of Gods).
- 6 Kanishka however, was a supporter of Buddhism and held the fourth Buddhist council in Kashmir.

POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

KUSHANA DYNASTY

INDIAN NATIONAL CALENDAR

MONTH	LENGTH	START DATE (GREGORIAN)
Chaitra	30/31	March 22*
Vaishakh	31	April 21
Jyaishta	31	May 22
Ashadha	31	June 22
Shravana	31	July 23
Bhadrapad	31	August 23
Ashwin	30	September 23
Kartik	30	October 23
Margashirsha (Agahayana)	30	November 23
Pausha	30	December 22
Magha	30	January 21
Phalguna	30	February 20

7 The reign had an important influence on Indian Art and Culture. **A new form of Buddhism, Mahayana Sect** emerged as the consequence of the 4th Buddhist Council.

8 Mahayana was patronized by Kanishka which helped in its spread not only in India, but from Gandhara to China.

9 **Saka Calendar** was started from **78 CE**, which is the national calendar of India.

POST MAURYAN PERIOD AND THEIR INFLUENCE ON ART AND CULTURE

KUSHANA DYNASTY

10 The Gandhara as well as Mathura School of Art flourished at this time. The Gandhara school had more of Greco-Roman influence with statues of Buddha having curly hair, sharp features of eyes, lips, etc.

11 The Mathura school was more indigenous. A number of large statues of Kushana rulers was found at Mathura, the most famous being the headless statue of Kanishka.

12 The early kushan kings issued numerous gold coins with higher degree of metallic purity.

GANDHARA AND MATHURA SCHOOLS OF ART



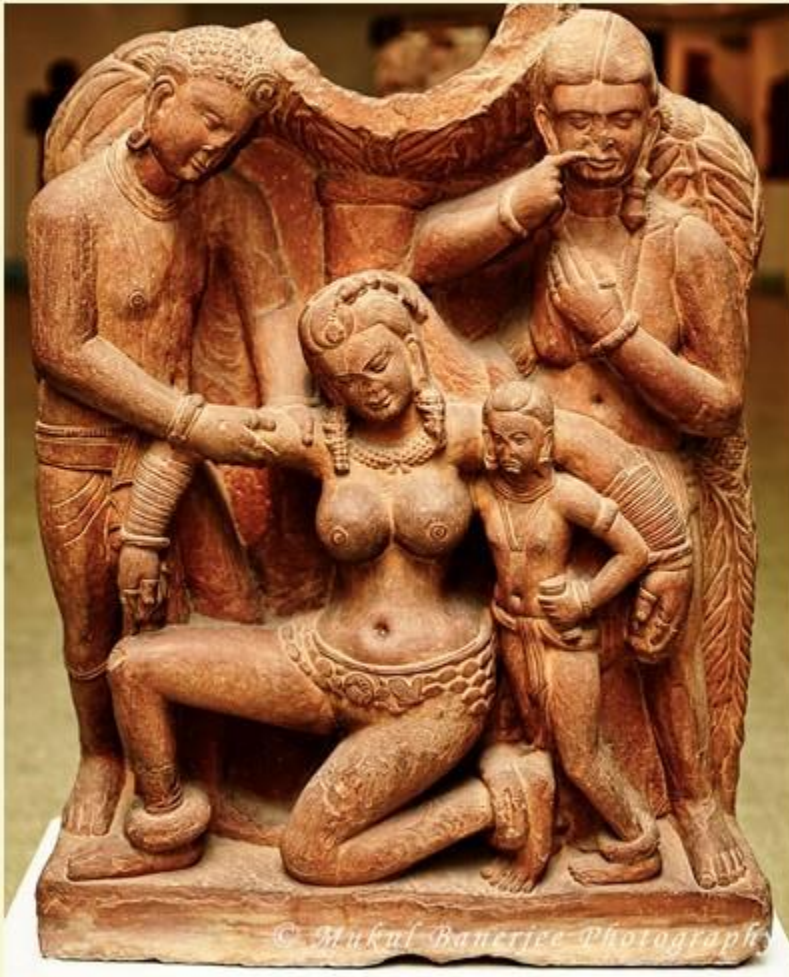
- 1 The foreign princes became enthusiastic patrons of Indian art and literature, and they showed the zeal characteristic of new converts.
- 2 The Kushan empire brought together masons and other artisans trained in different schools and countries.
- 3 This gave rise to several schools of art: **Central Asian, Gandhara, Mathura.**
- 4 Pieces of sculpture from Central Asia show synthesis of both local and Indian elements under the influence of Buddhism.

GANDHARA AND MATHURA SCHOOLS OF ART



- 5 Indian craftsmen came into contact with the Central Asians, Greeks and Romans, especially in the north-western frontier of India in Gandhara.
- 6 This gave rise to a new kind of art in which **images of the Buddha were made in the Graeco-Roman style.**
- 7 The hair of the Buddha was fashioned in the Graeco-Roman style.
- 8 The influence of the Gandhara art also spread to Mathura although it was primarily a centre of indigenous art.

GANDHARA AND MATHURA SCHOOLS OF ART



- 9 Mathura produced beautiful images of the Buddha but it is also famous for the headless erect statue of Kanishka whose name is inscribed on its lower part.
- 10 It also produced several stone images of Vardhamana Mahavira.
- 11 Its pre-Gupta sculptures ignore Krishna although Mathura is considered to be his birthplace and scene of early life.
- 12 The Mathura school of art flourished in the early centuries of the Christian era, and its products of red sandstone are found even outside Mathura.

GANDHARA AND MATHURA SCHOOLS OF ART

- 13** During the same period we notice beautiful works of art at several places south of the Vindhyas.



- 14** Beautiful Buddhist caves were constructed out of rocks in Maharashtra.
- 15** In Andhra Pradesh, Nagarjunakonda and Amaravati became great centres of Buddhist art, and the stories connected with the Buddha came to be portrayed in numerous panels.
- 16** The earliest panels dealing with Buddhism are found at Gaya, Sanchi and Bharhut, and belong to the second century B.C.
- 17** But we notice further development in sculpture in the early centuries of the Christian era.

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